Thursday, 1 January 2026 (12 Tevet 5786) — בית חוניו and the Possibility of Bringing קרבנות Today

Content-based review · reviewer read the transcripts, summary, and finished write-up · 1 November 2026

1.The Shiur in One Paragraph

A special Thursday-morning shiur at the Harbor View *beis medrash*, a continuation of the previous Thursday's talk on the temples that coexisted with the First and Second Temples (Elephantine, then *Beis Chonyo*). It opens with a recap and two asides on *Beis Chonyo*: the connection, suggested by the *Divrei Shaul* (R' Yosef Shaul Nathanson), between the Alexandrian artisans of *Yoma* (who failed to learn the *lechem hapanim* and the *ketores* from Beis Garmu and Beis Avtinas) and Chonyo's temple, balanced by the *Targum Sheni* on Achashveirosh's attempt to copy Shlomo's throne, and the length of time the temple stood (343, 250 or 200 years). It then gives the halachic problem (*shechutei chutz*), the three accounts of Chonyo (*avodah zarah* and the problem of the *yetzer hara*; the Rambam's Copts; Tosafos: only gentile offerings) and the *chiddush* of the *Toras Chaim* (a training facility), with the *bamos* objection from the room. The second half is the modern question: Rabbi Tzvi Hirsch Kalischer's *Drishas Tzion* and the choice of *korban Pesach*; the Rambam/Ra'avad dispute over *kedushah rishonah* and its consequence for going up to Har HaBayis; Kalischer's "either way" argument (a *bamah*), Rav Kook's reply in *Mishpat Kohen*, Rabbi Akiva Eiger's refusal of his student; the precedent of Rabbeinu Yechiel of Paris (Disputation of Paris, the burning of the Talmud, aliyah, and the report in *Kaftor VaFerach*); and the practical obstacles (*tumah* and the *tzitz*, no Sanhedrin or *Kohen Gadol*, the priestly garments

and *techeiles*, *argaman*, the exact place of the altar, the *zerikah* in the portions of Binyamin and Yehudah, and *yichus* of *kohanim*, with the Djerba DNA aside). It ends with Rav Kook to Rav Ovadia Hadaya: only with *Mashiach*.

2.Overall Fidelity

The finished write-up follows the order of the shiur and keeps most of its content. Three sources were read: the bilingual Plaud transcript (clearest; it glosses each Hebrew word and is authoritative on every point below), the Sofer-style transcript ("Speaker 1"; garbled, e.g. "Kiveiger" for Akiva Eiger), and the AI summary. **No Sofer .docx exists for this date**, so the Sofer .txt was treated as secondary to Plaud. **The pattern is the same as in previous weeks: the write-up inherited its misstatements from the summary.** The summary swaps the teacher of Kalischer (Vizhnitz for Akiva Eiger), puts the letter of refusal in the mouth of the Kovno Rav (R' Yitzchak Elchanan, who was not Kalischer's teacher), turns *Greiditz* into Grodno, misnames the *Toras Chaim*, garbles three speakers in the *mizbeach* passage, and names three people (R' Tendler, "Rav Shira Shuler," R' Avraham David Auerbach) that the recording does not name. Those are listed below; all were corrected in the final-MM HTML in the same pass, except where marked.

3.Content Flags — Misstatements and Overclaims

Flag 1 — Kalischer's teacher. The write-up has Kalischer as "a זיד of the Vizhnitzer rebbe" (and fn 11 noted the likely error). Plaud: "a זיד of עקיבא איגר," repeated three more times. Corrected. (Reference works also name R' Yaakov of Lissa.)

Flag 2 — The refusal came from Rabbi Akiva Eiger, not Rabbi Yitzchak Elchanan. Section X and fn 16 had the letter and the "I beg you, do not do it"

from יצחק אלחנן ספקטור מקובנא. Plaud: “he was a student of Rav Akiva Eiger… He wrote a letter to Rav Akiva Eiger… I have the teshuvah right here, a famous letter of Rav Akiva Eiger to his student.” The Sofer transcript has “Kiveiger.” Chronologically the summary’s version cannot stand either (R’ Yitzchak Elchanan was born in 1817, Kalischer in 1795). Corrected in the heading, body and fn 16.

Flag 3 — Gutmacher of *Greiditz*, not Grodno. Plaud: “Rav Eliyahu Gredetzar… Rav Eliyahu Gutmacher” (the Tzaddik of Greiditz), also a student of Rabbi Akiva Eiger, and recognizable “from the ו in the back of the א.” Corrected to Greiditz, and to a student of Akiva Eiger.

Flag 4 — The author of the *Toras Chaim*. The write-up has “ר. חיים שור” and fn 7 “1572–1632, חיים בן שמואל שור, Lublin/Belz.” Plaud: “ר׳ סנהדרין בבא on ים, one of the most important ה־ חיים שור, תורת חיים… and other א בתות.” Corrected (name; the Jewish Encyclopedia gives his death at Belz in 1632; the birth year was not confirmed and was dropped).

Flag 5 — Who wrote what in the *mizbeach* passage. The write-up: “רבי חיים שמעון סופר writes to his son-in-law (the ד): ‘you are an old man living in Europe…’” Plaud: Rav Chaim **Sonnenfeld**, then in Jerusalem, wrote “to one of his friends, Rav Shimon Sofer… an יקל of the ם סופר”; and it was **the Chasam Sofer himself, writing to his father-in-law Rabbi Akiva Eiger**, who said “you’re an old man living in Europe, you don’t know what’s going on in Eretz Yisrael; I get letters every day.” Corrected. (R’ Shimon Sofer’s title is unclear in both transcripts: “Leyerer Rav,” “L’Cham Soifer.”)

Flag 6 — “Show me לת” is Rabbi Akiva Eiger, and the reply is Kalischer’s. The write-up has “אברהם דוד אוערבאך writes: show me ת׳” and “שירא שולר ב rejects his ’s words.” Plaud: “Rav Akiva Eiger right away writes… to his זיד, ‘Show me techeiles,’” and “Rav Tzvi Hirsch Kalischer rejects his rebbe’s ה׳.” Neither Auerbach nor Shira Shuler appears. Corrected.

Flag 7 — *Hutrah* is Kalischer’s, not Ishtori’s. Section XII: “רב אשתורי

writes ‘רה׳’ but according to the Rambam that is not correct.” Plaud: “Rav Tzvi Hirsch Kalischer writes: Na-na, it’s רה׳ בציבור, it’s fine… It’s not really true according to the Rambam.” (In the earlier Ishtori passage the speaker who “jumps” to אה הותרה בציבור is ambiguous in the recording; left as is. Fn 20’s sentence that Ishtori’s reading “presupposes רה׳” therefore rests on the writer’s inference.)

Flag 8 — Ishtori Haparchi is early 14th century, not “the end of the 1200s.” The summary says the end of the 1200s; Plaud has “the late 1300s” (a slip, since the lecturer also says Ishtori wrote about 100 years after Rabbeinu Yechiel, who died c. 1268). Standard references: 1280–1355, *Kaftor VaFerach* written in 1322. Corrected to “early 1300s.” fn 17 (“a student of the Rosh”) hedged.

Flag 9 — “טנדלר also held that one could go.” Not in Plaud (“Often those held you could go there”) or in the Sofer transcript. Replaced with “Others of this type also hold that one may go.”

Flag 10 — The Rambam “at the beginning of נות בית הבחירה.” The lecturer says it (twice); the passage on offering without a Temple and on *kedushah rishonah* is *Hilchos Beis HaBechirah* 6:14–16 (checked on Sefaria). The place of the altar is indeed 2:1. The wording was changed to “in הלכות בית הבחירה.”

Flag 11 — Smaller notes. “Lyssa, 1862” (fn 11) is Lyck, 1862 (the lecturer said 1861). The “Parah Adumah” in Section V (“without a ז אדומה there is no purification”) is a gloss: the lecturer says only that אה וטהרה is the issue “until Mashiach comes.” True as halachah; not his words. Left, and noted in the Sefer Edition as the editor’s.

4.Content Flags — Omissions

Said in the shiur and left out of the write-up. The first two are substantive.

- **The questions of the room on *Beis Chonyo*.** R’ Dovid: the fact that

a *kohen* served there is not proof that the offering was by a gentile (the lecturer: “correct, this is only one *shitah*”); the *Sfas Emes* on this, citing *Kiddushin*. R’ Yitzchak: why was it so important to Chonyo? — the lecturer says he would love a historian to answer. Also Josephus: Chonyo as a *grandson* of Shimon HaTzaddik, where tradition says *son*. The lecturer on the *Toras Chaim*: “he goes back and forth, he is not sure.”

- **The Brisker Rov and *Kodshim*.** The Chofetz Chaim’s urging to learn *Kodshim* in the write-up is one clause; the shiur has the story of Rav Chaim Brisker bringing his son R’ Yitzchak Zev to the Chofetz Chaim (“you are the future of *Kodshim*”), the *yeshivos* that learn only *Kodshim* (now fifteen or twenty), and *Machon HaMikdash* and Ateret Kohanim (Rav Aviner), who reenact the service.

- **The Ra’avad’s “כך נגלה סוד ה’ ליראיו”** and the dispute whether it means *ruach hakodesh* (the Rim of Levin: *siyata dishmaya*), with *Torah lo bashamayim hi*; and that the Ra’avad says the same in *Hilchos Lulav*.

- **The Temple Mount asides:** the Briskers who stand at the back of the plaza; Satmar going only at night; the grandfather’s joke on a person learning *Daf Yomi* in Hebrew at the Kosel; those who go up have protocols of purification which are problematic according to the Rambam (partly in the write-up).

- **The “either way” argument in full:** Rabbi Akiva Eiger’s *mimah nafshach*; whether the *bamah* would be a *bamas yachid* or *bamas tzibbur*; the need for a *keren yesod*.

- **The foundation of the wall:** *Al naharos Bavel* — “ערו ערו עד היסוד בה” for the First Temple, but the Second left a wall; the *machlokes Tannaim* on the exact spot; and the position of the Ark.

- **Ishtori’s forgotten questions:** he forgot to ask Reb Boruch about *tumah and bigdei kehunah* (the write-up has only *tumah*).

- **Rabbeinu Yechiel:** the Mélenchon aside; where he settled and

whether he returned to France (“a whole question”); Rashi’s *karsi/yarok* on *techeiles*; Rav Elyashiv’s *techeiles* (raised by a congregant).

- **The end:** Rav Tzvi Yehudah Kook (and the *Nazir*, Rav David Cohen) and the disagreement among Rav Kook’s students; the young men with a shofar on the Mount (“nothing is going to happen until Mashiach”). The Djerba note: the terror attack a few years ago.

5.Added or Editorial Material Not in the Shiur

Several footnotes carry background that the lecturer did not say. Most is plausible; some conflicted with what he said or could not be verified.

- **fn 7:** dates and place for the *Toras Chaim* (see Flag 4). **fn 17:** “a student of the Rosh” (hedged). **fn 9:** “1810–1875” (not checked).
- **fn 11:** the Rothschild and Montefiore correspondence and the “Chasam Sofer’s family” (not in the shiur; not confirmed). **fn 12:** the Chasam Sofer “generally cautious but supportive in principle” (the lecturer: he is unsure whether we may give on behalf of the lost brothers). **fn 20:** “the Rosh and others הותרה” (not in the shiur; not verified). **fn 21:** the Ptil Tekhelet note. **fn 22:** the author’s full name (Dembitzer), with a working “verify” note. **fn 23, 24:** biographical detail and a citation (*Lechem Shamayim*) not in the shiur.
- **fn 8:** the claim that the Mishnah “records this as a שבח” is not checked; the Gemara (*Yoma* 38a, confirmed) has the Alexandrians failing in both crafts.

6.Halachic / Lomdish Observations

- **The Rambam on Chonyo.** Checked on Sefaria (Commentary on the

Mishnah, *Menachos* 13:10): Chonyo dressed his older brother Shimi in women's garments, falsely accused him, and fled to Alexandria; the Egyptians who joined him, called *Kavtzar* (Copts), offered sacrifices there; the Rambam says it was not idolatry but a violation of the one chosen place, and that it stood 200 years. This fits the lecturer, who adds that it was a cult of personality.

- **Rambam and Ra'avad.** *Beis HaBechirah* 6:14–16 (confirmed): sanctified "for its time and for the future"; offering without a house; Lev. 26:31. The Shechinah rationale (*shechinah einah beteilah*) is the standard commentary on 6:16, not the text of 6:14. The Ra'avad's disagreement is as the lecturer states; the consequence for entry in *tumah* is his own summary of the Ra'avad's view.
- ***Hutrah* or *dechuyah*.** *Pesachim* 77a (confirmed): *tumah hutrah* is held by R' Yehudah; R' Shimon holds *dechuyah* (not *hutrah*). The lecturer's statement that the Rambam rules *dechuyah* was not retrieved.
- **The Targum Sheni.** The retrieved text of Esther 1:2 on Sefaria has Shlomo's letter, the bird and the Queen of Sheba, and not the artisans; the throne story the lecturer cites was not located (the lecturer himself said it is a story "told to children in cheder").
- **Altar location and *kohanim*.** *Beis HaBechirah* 2:1 (confirmed: a very precise place that may never change). That Kalischer relies on *chazakah* for *kohanim* and the Chasam Sofer agrees, while the *Yam shel Shlomo* and others require *yichus*, is the lecturer's report; the sources were not retrieved.

7.Follow-up Questions Worth Asking the Rav

Q1.Where is Rabbi Akiva Eiger's letter to Kalischer (which volume of his responsa), and what does it say about the *techeiles* of the *avnet*?

> Q2.Which passage of the *Toras Chaim* (on which tractate) has the “training facility”?

> Q3.Who is the author of *Avodah Tamah* (Rav Chaim Nosson who?), and is Rav Tzvi Pesach Frank’s opposition in *Mikdash Melech*?

> Q4.Rav Shimon Sofer: which one (Krakow or Erlau)? Where is Rav Sonnenfeld’s letter?

> Q5.The passage in *Kaftor VaFerach* on Reb Boruch and Rabbeinu Yechiel; and who “jumps” to *tumah hutrah betzibur* (Ishtori, the lecturer, or Kalischer)?

> Q6.The Rambam on *dechuyah*: which halachah? And the Chasam Sofer’s responsa (the siman) on giving for lost Jews and on *kohanim*?

> Q7.Which *Mishpat Kohen* simanim, and what is the “who dares” passage’s wording?

> Q8.The *Divrei Shaul*: where does Nathanson make the Alexandria connection?

> Q9.Who were the “others” who held one may go up to Har HaBayis?

8.Bottom Line

> *A faithful, well-ordered write-up of a discursive and very good shiur. As before, its errors came mostly from the summary, and this week they clustered in one place: who said what to whom among Kalischer, Rabbi Akiva Eiger, the Chasam Sofer, Sonnenfeld and Shimon Sofer, and the techeiles exchange. With those fixed, the Ishtori century corrected, and the room’s questions, the Brisker Rov story and the Ra’avad’s “secret of the Lord” restored, the sefer edition can stand. The weakest footnotes (7, 11, 12, 20, 22–24) state more than the shiur or the sources support and should be hedged.*

Produced by a content-based review pass reading the Plaud transcript, the Sofer-style transcript, the AI summary, and the finished write-up (as

delivered, before the corrections described above were applied). No Sofer .docx was present for this date.